

Off-Flavour Detective

3 to 6 players



A batch has gone wrong. Which fault, in which beer, found in which room? Question the team and crack the case.

✓ 3 to 6 players

🕒 45 minutes

★ Ages 12+

🔍 Free from Craft Beer School





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45 minutes



Ages 12+

How to play

Rules

Set up

1. Sort the cards into faults, beers and rooms. Without looking, put one of each in the case file envelope.
2. Shuffle the rest together and deal them all out. Some players may get one more card than others.
3. Everyone takes a notebook and ticks the cards in their own hand. All caps start in the Taproom.

On your turn

1. Move your cap through a gold door into the next room, or take a pipe from a corner room to the opposite corner.
2. In your new room you may make a suggestion: "I think it was **oxidation** in the **Pilsner**, found in the **Cold Room**." The room must be the one you are in.
3. The player to your left shows you one matching card in secret if they hold any. If not, the next player tries, then the next.
4. Once a card has been shown to you, or nobody can show one, your turn ends. Note what you learned.

Solving the case

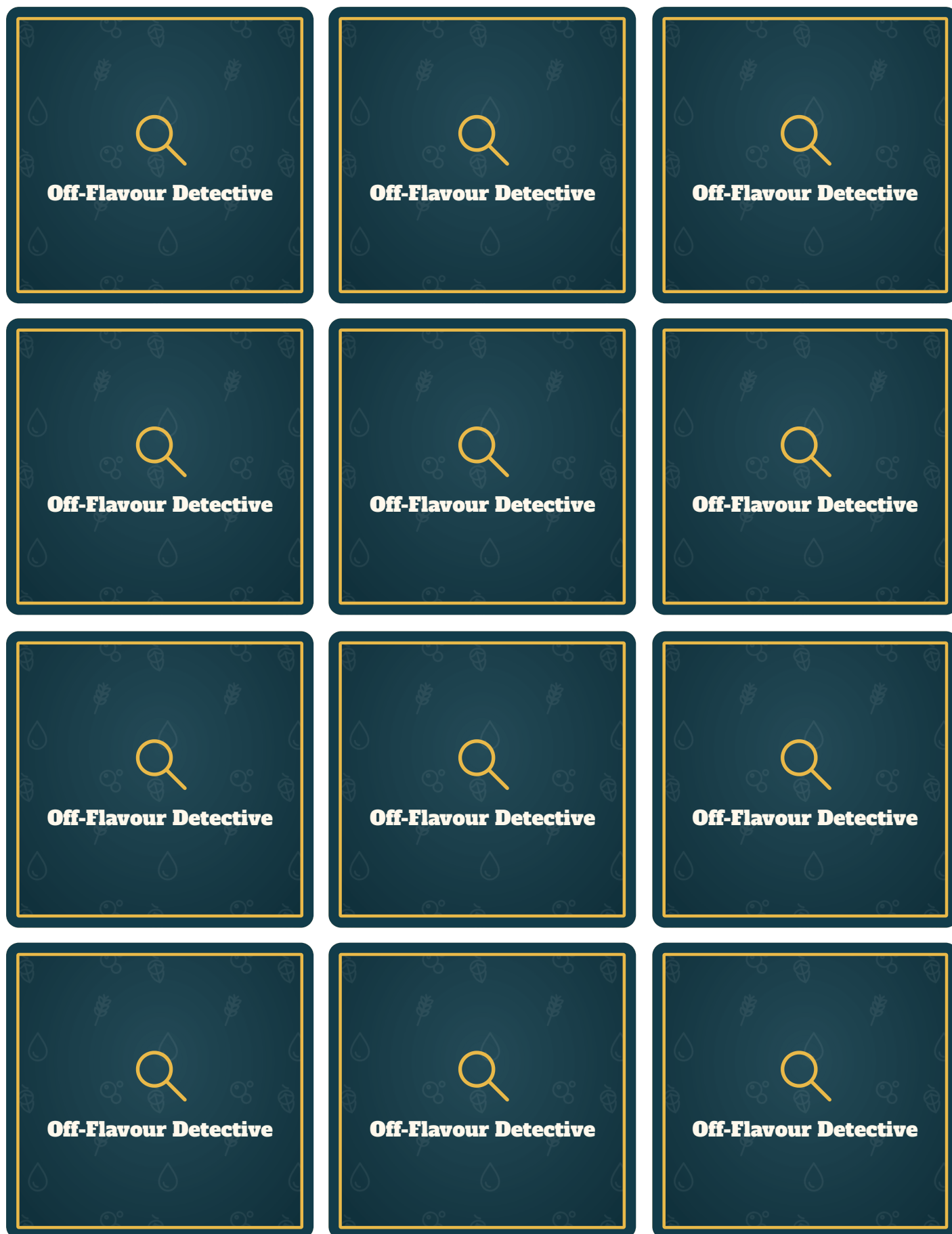
1. Once per game, on your turn, you may accuse: name a fault, a beer and a room, then check the case file in secret.
2. All three right and you win. Read the fault card out loud so everyone learns how to prevent it.
3. Wrong and you are out of the running, but you still show cards when asked.

Learn the faults. Every fault card lists its aroma, its usual cause and how brewers prevent it. Pair the game with an off-flavour spiking kit and let players smell the real thing before they accuse.

Clue cards. Cut along the edges.

Fault  Diacetyl Smells like: Butter, butterscotch. Cause: Beer packaged before the yeast reabsorbed it, or a bacterial infection. Prevent: Hold a warm diacetyl rest and check by forcing a sample before crashing.	Fault  DMS Smells like: Cooked sweetcorn, tinned vegetables. Cause: A weak or covered boil, or wort left hot too long before chilling. Prevent: Boil hard with the lid off and chill quickly.	Fault  Acetaldehyde Smells like: Green apple, fresh-cut pumpkin. Cause: Beer taken off the yeast too early, or unhealthy yeast. Prevent: Pitch enough healthy yeast and give fermentation time to finish.
Fault  Oxidation Smells like: Wet cardboard, sherry, stale bread. Cause: Oxygen picked up after fermentation, usually in transfer or packaging. Prevent: Purge tanks and kegs with CO2 and measure dissolved oxygen.	Fault  Lightstruck Smells like: Skunk, burnt rubber. Cause: Light hitting hop compounds, worst in clear or green glass. Prevent: Use brown glass or cans and keep beer out of the sun.	Fault  Sour infection Smells like: Vinegar, sour milk. Cause: Bacteria from poor cleaning or a dirty draught line. Prevent: Clean, then sanitise, everything that touches the beer.
Beer  Pilsner One of the six beers in the brewery this week.	Beer  Helles One of the six beers in the brewery this week.	Beer  Hefeweizen One of the six beers in the brewery this week.
Beer  American IPA One of the six beers in the brewery this week.	Beer  Dry Stout One of the six beers in the brewery this week.	Beer  Saison One of the six beers in the brewery this week.

Card backs. Print on the reverse of the sheet before.



Clue cards. Cut along the edges.

Room 

Malt Store
Where the fault was found.

Room 

Mill Room
Where the fault was found.

Room 

Brewhouse
Where the fault was found.

Room 

QC Lab
Where the fault was found.

Room 

Fermentation Hall
Where the fault was found.

Room 

Cold Room
Where the fault was found.

Room 

Taproom
Where the fault was found.

Room 

Keg Store
Where the fault was found.

Room 

Packaging Line
Where the fault was found.

Case file 

Top secret
Fold an envelope or a sheet of paper around this card. Place one fault, one beer and one room inside, unseen.

Card backs. Print on the reverse of the sheet before.



Detective notebook

Player columns: tick what you have seen, cross what you rule out

	P1	P2	P3	P4	P5
Fault					
Diacetyl					
DMS					
Acetaldehyde					
Oxidation					
Lightstruck					
Sour infection					
Beer					
Pilsner					
Helles					
Hefeweizen					
American IPA					
Dry Stout					
Saison					
Room					
Malt Store					
Mill Room					
Brewhouse					
QC Lab					
Fermentation Hall					
Cold Room					
Taproom					
Keg Store					
Packaging Line					

Cut out

Pieces and die

Print on thick paper or card. Cut out the caps and glue each onto a coin or a real bottle cap so it sits flat. Fold the die along the lines and glue the grey tabs inside. Or just use any die you have.



Inspector Malt



Inspector Hop



Inspector Yeast



Inspector Water



Inspector Stout



Inspector Teal

